GMS WEEKLY

Your Source for Recycling News

February 20th, 2026
Week 8
Volume 281, Issue 1224

Highlights:

- **CNY pause.**
- **Price push.**
- **Doc clarity.**
- **Ramadan ensues.**
- **Freight flying.**

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QUOTE of the WEEK

"The best way to predict the future is to create it."

– Abraham Lincoln

-- MARKET COMMENTARY --

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RAGING HANGOVER!

International market turmoil from the direct / indirect imposition of global tariffs and related actions by Donnie Dementia saw a crazy Week 8 wind up in 2026, as freight rates and oil prices both moved up and subsequently reconsidered their moves, retracing their steps before the week ended. The U.S. Dollar and local steel plate prices reformulated their individual strategies as they returned mixed results of their own across the various sub-continent destinations — all in the midst of rising inflation in a confusion-laden ship recycling industry. To start, let's paint a clearer picture of the international state of affairs as of January 2026, with key inflation figures from Trump's wrap-up of his year one "presidency." U.S. inflationary figures (un?)surprisingly fell to 2.4% (from 2.7% in both of the preceding months), even as the cost of living rises and the populace responsible for the performance of the economy collectively tightens their purse strings. Turkey's figures for last month followed suit in the path of U.S. numbers, while Indian, Pakistani, and Bangladeshi figures all rose in unison.

As oil rose above USD 63/barrel from last week to well over USD 66/barrel this week, it retreated back down to USD 65.93/barrel by week's end, amid investors and forecasters increasingly weighing the deranged possibility of Donnie Silver Spoon launching another confounding attack against Iran, in an ongoing effort to distract from the JE files (having failed with his bid involving President Maduro's kidnapping just last month), and still failing. The Baltic Exchange's Dry Bulk Index, meanwhile, snapped a three-day losing streak by the end of the week and climbed a healthy 1.2% on the back of Capes (which rebounded a healthy 1.7%) and Panamaxes (which rose 1.2%), despite Supras easing by 1 point. All of the above showed a different face in the ship recycling markets, as local anchorages were relatively stacked this week, with a collective 151K LDT via 16 vessels that arrived and were delivered across India, Bangladesh, and Pakistan — a truly welcome change for the industry.

Chinese New Year holidays also came this week and, while an anticipated drop in the supply of potential tonnage remains omnipresent and was expected to spell further doom for sub-continent ship recycling markets after an altogether dull start to the year, this week's reported local anchorages did seem to turn the tables on that. Prices, meanwhile, seem to be confoundingly moving up again toward the mid-USD 400s/LDT for select, good-condition vessels, spurred on by a positive election in Bangladesh, an apparent halt to cheap Iranian steel imports in Pakistan, and India still reining in tonnage despite being on shaky ground. The HKC landscape and required documentation are also becoming much clearer, as the Association in Bangladesh will now adhere to the processes in place in both Gadani and Alang, whereby IRRCs (International Readiness for Recycling Certificates) will now be required on incoming vessels. Finally, the Holy Month of Ramadan is now upon us, meaning official working hours are likely to be reduced before the breaking of fast in the evenings. It seems like a slow fortnight (or more) may be upon us.

GMS market rankings / pricing for week 8 of 2026 are on Page 6.

BANGLADESH

JACK-IN-THE-BOX!

BNP victory.

Like a jack-in-the-box springing back to life, this week Bangladesh worked its way back to the top of the market rankings board — an impressive move given the state of local fundamentals, the economy, and the nation overall. Ever since the election victory for the country's second-largest political party, the BNP, was declared last week with a two-thirds majority, the bounce in the step certainly seems to be back as Chattogram Choppers started offering some really strong numbers on decent LDT and well-conditioned market/private tonnage that made it to the tables this week.

Leapfrog.

Taking a step back to truly appreciate the scenario: leapfrogging a bullish Pakistan has been no easy feat for Bangladeshi recyclers, especially with ongoing HKC yard accreditations in Gadani — which now has two domestic yards on the roster and growing international interest once again — alongside an improving Pakistani economy and demand in Gadani that has built up over the last four months amid a near-zero number of local arrivals. Chattogram recyclers had to really drop the hammer and are now seeing the best levels across the Indian sub-continent ship recycling sector once again.

Larger LDT pref.

While the preference-backed pricing has primarily been for good/decent-condition larger LDT units, the attractive pricing certainly helped reel in the second Cape bulker of the year, which was delivered locally this week. In fact, speaking of local deliveries, the anchorage itself was impressive — not only was a collection of larger LDT bulkers delivered, but they were topped by a near 27K LDT LNG unit that remains idling outside awaiting delivery. Impressively, local market news also reports that several LNG units are still working toward onward sale into Chattogram in the weeks ahead. Well timed, considering reports highlight Bangladeshi inflation climbing from 8.49% in December 2025 to 8.58% in January 2026 — not an entirely alarming rise by any stretch of the imagination, but just enough to add pressure on local costs.

Spring and sunshine.

And with the rear-view mirror presenting a darker period for Chattogram Choppers, a freshly elected and popular government, a Taka that firmed a healthy 0.31% against the U.S. Dollar, and local steel plate prices that posted a massive USD 16/ton jump this week suggest that March might just deliver spring and sunshine.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

INDIA

HAVE MY CAKE& EAT IT!

Amid the smattering of sanctioned vessels that continue to arrive into India, Alang buyers are still taking in their fair share of specialist vessels and geographically positioned units of all LDTs and types. Local port positioning demonstrates not only the type and distribution of LDTs on the board, but also highlights a fairly even share of vessels between all sub-continent markets (with Bangladesh well ahead in terms of total LDT, as expected).

Smattering.

With the fundamentals still playing hide-and-seek with stability in the minds of local recyclers, encouraging signs finally seem to be emerging in Alang despite the ongoing chaos and a rocky end to 2025. Highlighting the turbulence, the Indian Rupee lost 0.15% against the U.S. Dollar and ended the week at Rs. 90.76. Meanwhile, local steel plate prices also took a carnival ride, losing nearly USD 4/ton and ending the week below the dreaded USD 400/ton mark (at USD 399).

Hide-and-go-seek.

On the economic front, India's inflation jumped to 2.75% in January, well above domestic market expectations of landing near 2.4%. What is particularly noteworthy is that, from a low of 0.25% (firm stagflation territory) back in October 2025, India's inflation has risen steadily each month — 0.71% in November, 1.33% in December, and now 2.75% in January.

Coupled with domestic growth, this heated rise also carries a heavy dose of Trumpian "Victory Dressing." Speaking of which, the fact that the Supreme Court of the United States reversed all of Donnie's unbridled global tariffs on Friday reportedly sent him into a rage on Saturday, tweeting out policy declaring that the U.S. would levy an additional 15% tariff on the world under a 1970s law that does not support his justification. As such, India (and the world) can certainly expect rough waters sailing into March.

Select edge.

Overall, even though Alang buyers are unable to compete on favored larger LDT units with the likes of Pakistan and Bangladesh, India will always hold the advantage in taking in specialist non-ferrous units and offshore vessels. It retains the edge with the most — and some of the highest-standard — HKC yards available, and remains the one destination that will not run out of space, even when the competition gets stuffed.

Get stuffed.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

PAKISTAN

QUICK RELINQUISH!

Missing out.

Pakistan has already relinquished the top spot to a resurgent Bangladesh this week, in the wake of the welcome victory for the BNP party there (which should hopefully lead to further stability in Chattogram as renewed impetus on critical infrastructure projects takes hold).

Nevertheless, it has certainly been an encouraging run for Gadani so far this year. With several larger units (particularly on the dry bulk side) having been concluded to hungry Gadani buyers at some of the best rates on show across the sub-continent, local anchorage has finally started to spill the beans on the state of recent fixtures, with a healthy collection beginning to gather at the waterfront.

Good run.

In fact, it has truly been a sight for sore eyes to witness five vessels at Gadani's waterfront this week (some delivered and some in the process of delivery). The variety in type and variance in LDT is also a welcome break from the mundane for local recyclers who, as the types of units confirm, tend to stay on the straight and narrow.

Despite local fundamentals performing comparatively healthier than the competition and doing their best to support Gadani buyers — with local steel plate prices still flatlining at the highest in the industry at USD 594/ton, and the Pakistan Rupee snaring a healthy 0.40% against the U.S. Dollar to close the week at PKR 278.49 — what remains confounding is the incredible volatility behind the purchasing mindset and trends arising out of Pakistan since last year.

Cessation.

While the cessation of Iranian steel dumping has, for the time being, given end buyers added confidence to fill dormant plots again, what about the prior months — and much of 2025 — when the situation was fairly similar, yet Gadani yards languished in isolation? Perhaps inflationary trends are responsible for this performance: inflation fell as low as 0.3% back in April 2025, rose to 4.1% by August, crossed over 6.2% by October, wrapped up 2025 at 5.6%, and rose again in January to 5.8%.

This kind of volatility, backed by Trump's 30% tariffs on various nations, could well be contributing to the overall fragility of local offerings at the bidding tables. But with local yards now becoming HKC-certified and a decent supply of incoming tonnage, let's hope 2026 is the year Pakistan finally breaks past 25 ships in a year.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

TURKEY

SAVING GRACE!

Stomach full.

Other than the monotony of the ailing Lira (which lost another 0.26% against the U.S. Dollar and wrapped the week up at TRY 43.84) and the occasional sprinkle of cheer via a sudden surge of tonnage, Aliaga yards have been stuck at the extreme ends of an overstretched rubber band, with inflation filling in the middle.

Released figures indicate Turkey's annual inflation eased marginally from 30.89% in December 2025 to 30.65% in January. However, it remained notably above market expectations of 20%. Moreover, with rising costs of food and consumables, consumer prices reportedly surged to a one-year high of 4.84%.

With rising costs, steady inflation, and muted supply, local recyclers have little more than a stomach full of desperation to keep them fueled.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

GMS Weekly – Market Rankings

For Week 8 of 2026, GMS Market Rankings / vessel indications are as below.

Rank	Location	Sentiment	Dry Bulk USD / LDT	Tankers USD / LDT	Containers USD / LDT
1	Bangladesh	**Improving**	425 / LDT	445 / LDT	455 / LDT
2	Pakistan	**Steady**	420 / LDT	440 / LDT	450 / LDT
3	India	**Steady**	410 / LDT	430 / LDT	440 / LDT
4	Turkey	**Steady**	270 / LDT	280 / LDT	290 / LDT

ANOTHER…2025 IN REVIEW!!

- *Oct 12 - Madagascar President Andry Rajoelina fled the country after the military sided with Gen Z-led protestors.*
- *Oct 19 - Thieves disguised as construction workers stole over $100 million in Napoleonic jewels from the Louvre Museum in a daylight heist.*
- *Nov 03 - People magazine named Jonathan Bailey its "Sexiest Man Alive" for 2025, making him the first openly gay man to receive the title.*
- *Nov 04 - Zohran Mamdani was elected as the 111th mayor of New York City.*
- *Nov 12 - The United States Mint in Philadelphia made the last-ever penny for general use, ending over two centuries of production.*
- *Nov 23 - Ethiopia's Hayli Gubbi volcano erupted for the first time in recorded history, and no one was injured.*
- *Dec 03 - The Malaysian Government announced the resumption of the search for flight MH370.*
- *Dec 10 - Australia became the first country in the world to ban under-16s from social media.*
- *Dec 14 - Two gunmen killed 15 people at an event celebrating the first day of Hanukkah in Bondi Beach, Australia.*
- *Dec 20 - German engineer Michaela Benthaus became the first wheelchair user to travel to space.*

IMPORTANT DATES

INDIA	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
March 04 – Holi March 21 – Eid-ul-Fitr (subj. to Moon sighting) March 26 – Ram Navami March 31 – Mahavir Jayanthi	February 16 – February 23 March 01 – March 07 March 18 – March 24

BANGLADESH	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
March 19 – Eid-ul-Fitr March 20 – March 23 – Jumatul Bidah + Eid Day 2 & 3 March 26 – Independence Day	March 04 – March 07 March 19 – March 22

BANK HOLIDAYS	
PAKISTAN	**TURKEY**
March 21 – March 23 – Eid-ul-Fitr Days 1, 2, & 3	March 19 – March 23 - Eid-ul-Fitr & Ramzan Bayrami

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ALANG - Port Position as of February 13, 2026

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Diana	15,065	Oil Tanker	Arrived February 13
2	Dimple	4,869	Bulk Carrier	Arrived February 13
3	*J M A*	*2,505*	*Oil Tanker*	*Delivered February 10*
4	*Saltlake*	*2,127*	*Reefer*	*Delivered February 10*
5	*Woodchip*	*22,800*	*Oil Tanker*	*Delivered February 06*
Morality		**47,366**		

CHATTOGRAM - Port Position as of February 13, 2026

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Beihai	24,181	Bulk Carrier	Arrived February 10
2	Chung	3,551	Cement Carrier	Arrived February 07
3	Hansung	2,731	RoRo	Arrived February 05
4	Sirrah	7,072	Bulk Carrier	Arrived February 13
		37,534		

GADANI - Port Position as of February 13, 2026

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Bright Ace	2,573	General Cargo	Arrived February 10
2	Jimei Fuhao	9,881	Bulk Carrier	Arrived February 05
3	Rui Tiger	10,198	Bulk Carrier	Arrived February 07
4	Sheng Le	6,961	Bulk Carrier	Arrived February 04
Total Tonnage		**29,612**		

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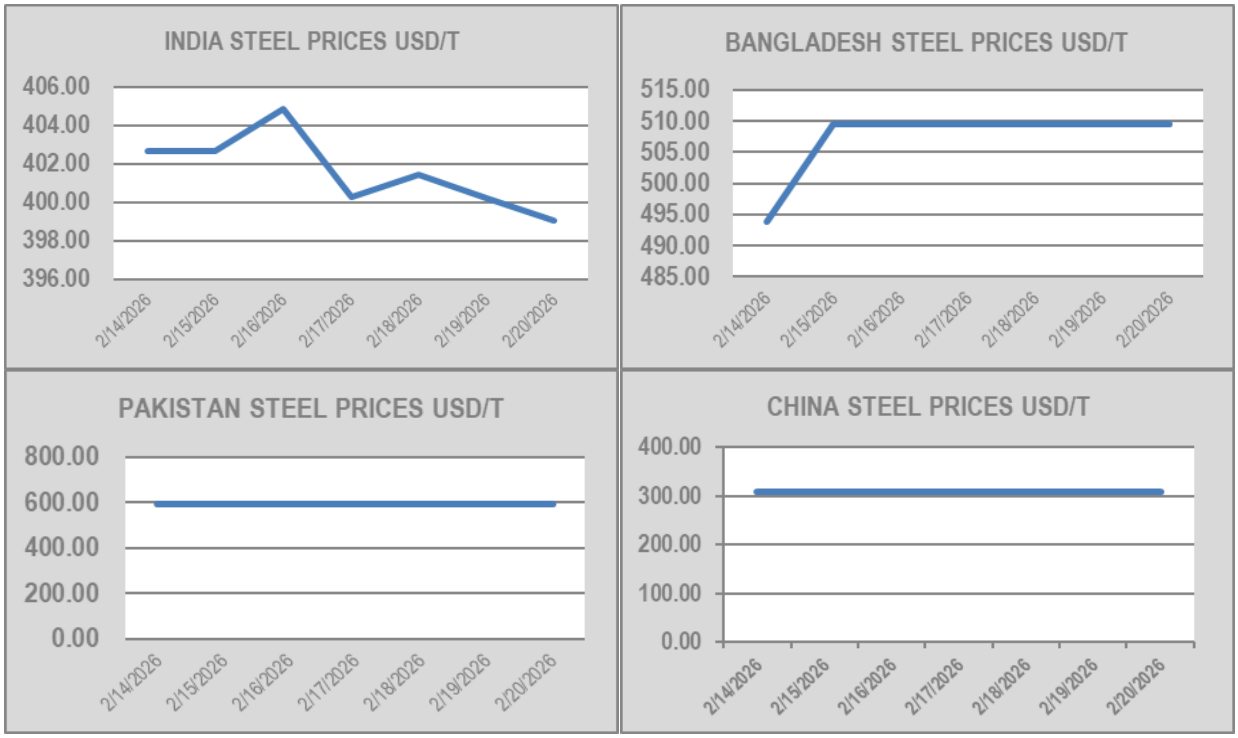
DATE	INDIA STEEL PRICES USD/T	INDIA STEEL PRICES	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES USD/T	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES USD/T	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES	CHINA STEEL PRICES USD/T
2/14/2026	402.69	36,500.00	594.09	167,000.00	493.84	60,100.00	308.91
2/15/2026	402.69	36,500.00	594.09	167,000.00	509.45	62,000.00	308.91
2/16/2026	404.85	36,700.00	594.09	167,000.00	509.45	62,000.00	308.91
2/17/2026	400.31	36,300.00	594.09	167,000.00	509.45	62,000.00	308.91
2/18/2026	401.41	36,400.00	594.09	167,000.00	509.45	62,000.00	308.91
2/19/2026	400.22	36,300.00	594.09	167,000.00	509.45	62,000.00	308.91
2/20/2026	399.03	36,300.00	594.09	167,000.00	509.45	62,000.00	308.91



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